

SPACE-AGE DENTISTRY

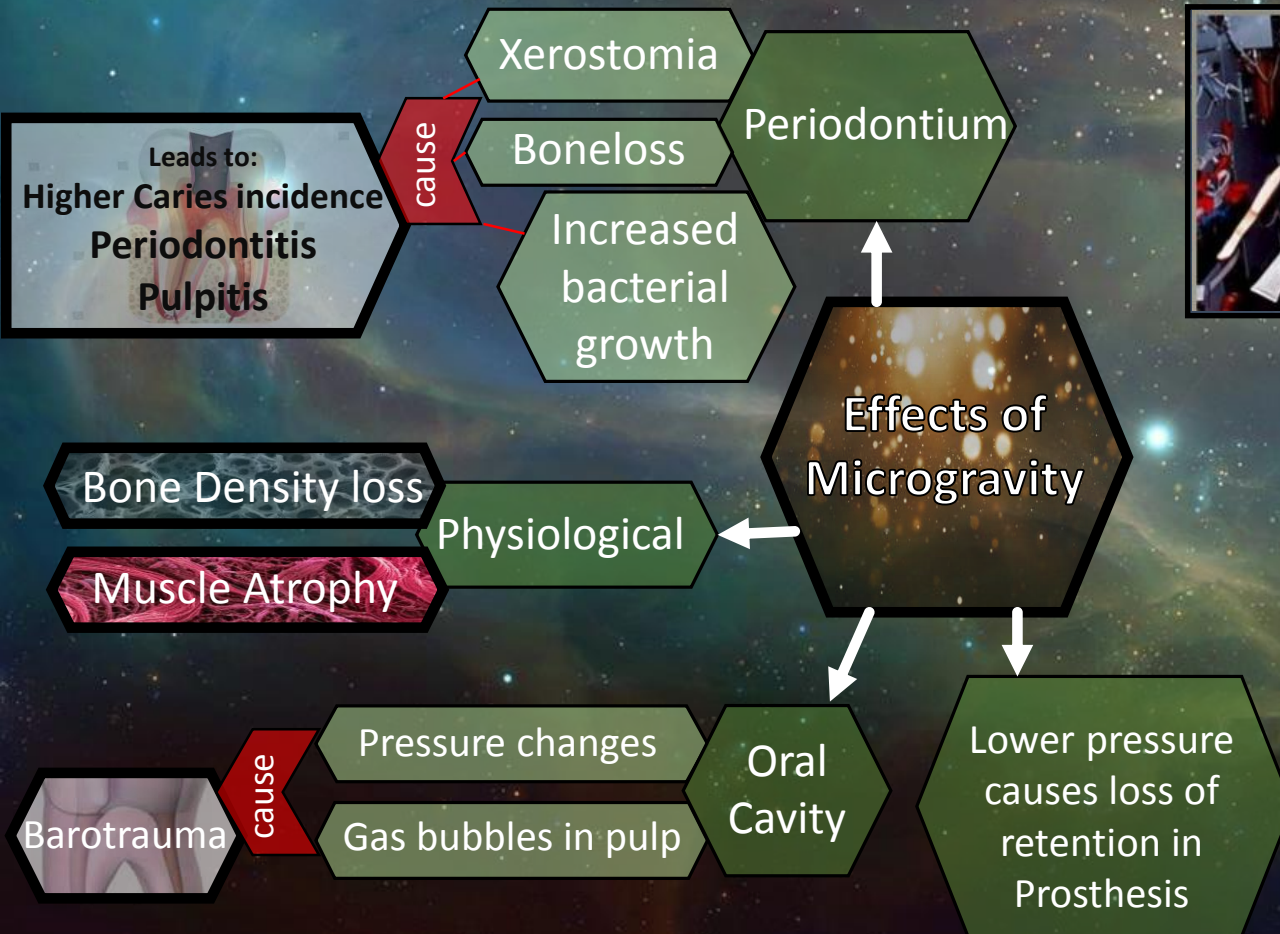
An Insight Into Aeronautic Dentistry

What is Aeronautic Dentistry?

Aeronautic dentistry is the specialized branch of dentistry that deals with the oro-dental factors in aeronautical and extraterrestrial environments

What is Microgravity?

It is a feeling of weightlessness experienced in high altitudes such as in high flying aircrafts and low earth orbits in space due to lower effect of the Earth's gravitational force on objects so far up



Dental Emergencies in Space

- Two dental emergencies occurred during March 14, 1995, through June 12, 1998.
- One dental emergency occurred during a Mars analogue.
- Two dental emergencies occurred during JBR study of Martian sol study



ORAL CARE IN SPACE MISSIONS:

- Astronauts must undergo extensive prophylactic evaluation and treatment prior to extensive space travel to avoid dental emergencies.
- In space astronauts swallow their toothpaste after brushing to save water and avoid a mess. So the toothpastes need to be non fluoridated (But that increases risk of caries)
- Space missions should also be equipped with a specialized dental kit to deal with dental emergencies that may arise on the space station.

FUTURE OF DENTAL AERONAUTICS

With a growing interest in space exploration and possible plans for colonization of other planets, Aeronautical Dentistry should be introduced in the curriculum of dental education. It is imperative for greater research in the field and refinement of treatment techniques for use in manned space missions.